

» MANISHA RAMADASS

Category: Badminton (Women's Singles SU5)

Manisha Ramadass became the first Indian woman to win a para-badminton medal at the Paralympics after clinching bronze in the women's singles SU5 category, which is for athletes with impairment in the upper limbs in the playing or non-playing hand.

The 19-year-old was born with Erb's Palsy, a nerve condition in the shoulder and arm that results in weakness or loss of muscle function. Manisha began her journey in 2019, competing alongside able-bodied players in the domestic circuit.

In 2022, her first year on the international circuit, she collected 11 gold and five bronze medals, becoming World No. 1 in her category. She also won the 2022 World Championships and was named BWF Female Para Badminton Player of the Year 2022.

Her success continued with a silver in the singles and a bronze in doubles with Mandeep Kaur at the 2024 World Championships.

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» NITHYA SRE SIVAN

Category: Badminton (Women's Singles SH6)

What started as a hobby with her friends has brought Nithya Sre Sivan multiple accolades on the international stage.

She won bronze in the para-badminton women's singles SH6 at the 2024 Paralympic Games after a 21-14, 21-6 win over Indonesia's Rina Marlina in the bronze medal match. The SH6 class is for athletes with short stature.

The 19-year-old's only loss at the Games came against China's Lin Shuangbao, once in the group stage and again in the semifinals. She also came close to bagging a medal in the mixed doubles SH6 with Sivarajan Solaimalai but lost in the bronze medal match against Indonesia's Marlina and her partner Subhan.

Nithya, who trains in Lucknow under national team coach Gaurav Khanna, also won two bronze medals at the 2023 Asian Para Games in Hangzhou, in women's doubles and mixed doubles.